



free will
and
determinism

against
compatibilist
free will

A large red circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is arranged in three lines, centered within the circle.

**against
incompatibilist
free will**

1. No one has any choice about events which happened in the distant past.
 2. No one has any choice about DINOSAUR.
(1)
 3. If determinism is true, then only one future is consistent with the state of the world at a time + the laws of nature.
 4. If determinism is true, then the laws of nature say that if DINOSAUR happens, then DECISION happens. (3)
 5. No one has any choice about what the laws of nature are.
 6. If determinism is true, then no one has any choice about the fact that if DINOSAUR then DECISION. (4,5)
 7. If no one has about choice about whether P, and no one has any choice about whether, if P, then Q, then no one has any choice about whether Q.
-

C. If determinism is true, then no one has any choice about DECISION. (2,6,7)

This argument seems to show that the combination of four theses — that No one has any choice about the past, no choice about the laws of nature, the no choice principle, and determinism — rules out free will.

Since the first three of these theses seem quite plausible, the argument seems to show that if determinism is true, there are no free actions — and hence that free will is incompatible with determinism.

The consequence argument

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

Real/|the master argument:

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe in free will, and find the consequence argument persuasive, it looks tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

We've now completed the defense of premise (2) of our
master argument:

If you find the consequence argument plausible, then it is natural to reject premise (3) of the master argument. What's so bad about adopting Libertarianism, and saying that free will is real, and incompatible with determinism?

1. Either (i) Compatibilism is true or (ii) Libertarianism is true or (iii) there is no free will.
2. Compatibilism is false.
3. Libertarianism is false.

C. There is no free will. (1,2,3)

THE MASTER ARGUMENT AGAINST THE REALITY OF FREE WILL



5. No one has any choice about what the laws

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

4. If determinism is true, the laws of

1. No one has any choice about events which

of interest.

happened in the distant past.

future is not just what the state of the



3. If determined, the only one

6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

then DECISION happens. (3)

theorie about the fact that if DNR

2. None has any choice about DIDS. ATJR.

7. If none has about choice about whether P,

varlatatie + the last of the



and none has any choice about whether,

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

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C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

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We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the

reality of free will.



The master argument against the reality of free will

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in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

master argument:

We've now completed the defense premise (2) of our

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so bad about adopting Libertarianism, and saying that free

If you find the consequence argument plausible, then it is





Libertarianism is true or (iii) there is no free

2. compatibilisme.

1. Either $(i) \text{Compat} i b i 1$ is true or $(i i)$

3:Libertarianism is false.

W i l l .

C. There is no free will. (1,2,3)



believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believer in free will rejects premise (1). An incompatibilist

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one

for (2), and one for (3).

A large orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text 'against compatibilist free will' in white, bold, sans-serif font.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

against
incompatibilist
free will

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

defenses.

But, we'll see now, this argument can also be given a plausible

One way to introduce this defense is with the following quote from

David Hume: